



# ADF Platform Documentation Guide

**User Guide • Admin Guide • Developer / Technical Guide**

A practical documentation structure for the Academic Development Forum platform, covering publishing, academic networking, bookstore operations, publication submissions, memberships, programmes, and administrative content management.

**Documentation principle:** Keep public-user instructions focused on what visitors and authors need to do, while the Admin Guide explains operational workflows and the Developer/Technical Guide explains implementation and system behavior.

# 1. Overview & Introduction

Academic Development Forum (ADF) is documented as a platform for publishing, academic networking, a bookstore, memberships, publication submissions, and administrative content management. The documentation should explain the platform in a way that supports both public users and internal staff.

## Purpose of ADF

- Publishing and dissemination of academic and literary work.
- Academic networking and engagement for authors, researchers, institutions, and readers.
- Bookstore access for discovering and purchasing published books.
- Publication-submission workflows for literary manuscripts and book chapters.
- Membership and academic programme participation.
- Administrative CMS capabilities for maintaining public-facing content.

## Target Audience

- Authors
- Researchers
- Academic institutions
- General readers
- Administrative staff and managers
- Technical/development team

## Key Features

- Bookstore
- Membership
- Publication Submissions
- Admin CMS
- Academic Programmes
- User Dashboard
- Orders and active submissions



# 2. Public User Guide — Visitors & Authors

## Account & SSO

- Register for an ADF account.
- Log in using the supported authentication/SSO flow.
- Use the user dashboard to view orders and active submissions.

## Bookstore

- Browse available books.
- Search for books and filter by categories.
- Add books to the shopping cart.

- Proceed through the payment checkout process.
- Review order information from the user dashboard.

## Literary Submissions

- Start a literary submission for a full book/manuscript.
- Provide the required manuscript information and synopsis.
- Upload the required files.
- Complete the submission/payment workflow as configured by ADF.
- Track the active submission from the user dashboard.

## Chapter Publications

- Browse available Open Calls / Volumes.
- Select the relevant volume.
- Submit a book chapter.
- Add co-author information.
- Provide the required payment transaction information.
- Track the submitted chapter through the available workflow.

## Memberships & Programmes

- Browse available Academic Programmes.
- Apply for an academic programme.
- Review available ADF membership options and details.



## 3. Admin Panel Guide — Staff & Managers

The Admin Guide should include screenshots for each major admin section. Screenshots should show the relevant controls, tables, status fields, forms, and action buttons so staff can follow the same workflow in the live system.

### Accessing the Admin Panel

- Open the designated Admin Panel login portal.
- Authenticate using an account with the required administrative role.
- Only authorized roles should access administrative publication, bookstore, order, and CMS controls.

### Managing Publications — Chapter Volumes

- Create a new Open Call / Volume.
- Set the submission deadline.
- Define the expected page count.
- Manage the volume information and its publication state.
- Review chapter submissions associated with the volume.

### Submission Workflows

- Review submitted manuscripts/chapters.
- Update submission stages, for example: Peer Review → Accepted → Published.
- Handle submissions that require further action.
- Delete spam submissions when appropriate.
- Maintain accurate status information so authors can follow progress.

### Bookstore Management — Inventory

- Manually add new books.
- Set book pricing.
- Upload book covers.
- Assign authors to books.
- Maintain the bookstore inventory information.

### Publishing from Submissions

- Use the “Publish to Store” action for an accepted literary manuscript.
- Convert the accepted submission into a live bookstore item.
- Confirm the book's store information before making it public.

### Orders

- Track customer orders.
- Review order details.
- Update fulfillment statuses.

### Content Management System (CMS)

- Manage homepage announcements.
- Manage featured videos.
- Manage gallery images.
- Keep public-facing content current and consistent with ADF branding.

## 4. Developer / Technical Guide

The supplied outline names a Developer/Technical Guide but does not specify its detailed technical subsections. This section should therefore document the actual implementation maintained by the development team rather than invent technical behavior not defined in the source.

### Recommended Technical Documentation Areas

- Application architecture and major modules.
- Authentication/SSO integration.
- User dashboard and submission data flow.
- Bookstore, cart, checkout, and order flow.
- Chapter volume and submission workflow.
- Literary submission and “Publish to Store” flow.
- Admin CMS content management.
- Role and permission requirements.
- Deployment, environment configuration, and maintenance procedures.

**Source limitation:** The supplied outline does not provide exact technology names, API contracts, database schema, payment provider details, or deployment commands. Those details should be added from the actual implementation rather than assumed.

## 5. Quick Workflow Reference

| Area                | Primary User Action                      | Admin Responsibility                   |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Account             | Register / Log in                        | Manage authorized access/roles         |
| Bookstore           | Browse → Cart → Checkout                 | Manage inventory and orders            |
| Literary Submission | Submit manuscript + synopsis/files       | Review and manage publication workflow |
| Chapter Publication | Choose Open Call/Volume → Submit chapter | Manage volume and review stages        |
| Memberships         | Browse / Apply                           | Manage programme/membership content    |
| CMS                 | View public content                      | Manage announcements, videos, gallery  |

End of guide — use screenshots from the live ADF platform alongside these sections for task-by-task staff instructions.